

SCENE 1

THE LAST QUESTION

Format: Cinematic Script

Context: A confrontation between the protagonist and an unknown entity that governs knowledge, death, and choice.

Focus: Philosophical conflict, power, responsibility.

INT. UNKNOWN CHAMBER – TIMELESS

Darkness.

A vast, undefined space. No clear walls. No sky.

A presence can be felt before it is seen.

A figure stands opposite the PROTAGONIST.

Its features are indistinct. Shifting. Unstable.

This is the **UNKNOWN**.

UNKNOWN

You came here seeking answers.

PROTAGONIST

I came here because you called me.

UNKNOWN

No.

You came because you needed to know.

A pause.

UNKNOWN

Curiosity is a powerful thing.

Strong enough to cross worlds.

Strong enough to defy death.

PROTAGONIST

You speak as if death were a doorway.

UNKNOWN

I speak as someone who has watched countless souls hesitate before it.

The UNKNOWN moves closer. The space around them seems to bend.

UNKNOWN

Death holds something cryptic.

Something visceral.

In its final instant, a life flashes — every choice, every regret, every truth laid bare.

PROTAGONIST

And you stand there to judge them?

UNKNOWN

Judge?

No.

A faint, almost amused pause.

UNKNOWN

I observe.

PROTAGONIST

Then why summon me?

UNKNOWN

Because you are different.

Silence.

UNKNOWN

You asked the question most are too afraid to ask.

PROTAGONIST

And what question is that?

UNKNOWN

Whether knowledge is worth the price it demands.

The air grows heavier.

PROTAGONIST

You speak in riddles.

UNKNOWN

Riddles are truths that refuse to be simple.

PROTAGONIST

Then speak plainly.

The UNKNOWN considers this.

UNKNOWN

Very well.

A step closer.

UNKNOWN

Every truth you uncover reshapes the world around you.
Every answer removes the comfort of ignorance.
And every step forward makes retreat impossible.

PROTAGONIST

So this is a warning?

UNKNOWN

It is an offer.

A beat.

UNKNOWN

Power, understanding, clarity.
At the cost of certainty.
At the cost of peace.

PROTAGONIST

You make it sound like a curse.

UNKNOWN

Most gifts are.

The UNKNOWN turns away slightly.

UNKNOWN

I would call myself more of a fanatic than a lunatic.

PROTAGONIST

For believing this is necessary?

UNKNOWN

For believing that ignorance is the greatest lie ever told.

The space trembles subtly.

UNKNOWN

The world you know survives because truths remain buried.
Exposed, they would tear it apart.

PROTAGONIST

Then why offer them at all?

The UNKNOWN faces the PROTAGONIST again.

UNKNOWN

Because someone always comes asking.

And someone always believes they are strong enough to carry the burden.

A long pause.

UNKNOWN

The question is not whether the truth should exist.

UNKNOWN

The question is whether *you* are willing to live with it.

Silence.

The UNKNOWN does not move.

The PROTAGONIST stands alone with the weight of the question.

END SCENE